How the cloud works.
Three ideas, nothing more.

Almost every question MACK asks will come back to one of these three ideas. If you understand them, you can explain any option.

1

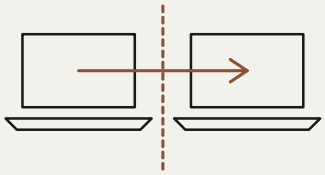


STORAGE

A company cupboard that lives on the internet.

All project files sit in one place owned by MACK (Google, Microsoft or Dropbox). Nobody keeps "their" copy. If a laptop dies, nothing is lost.

2

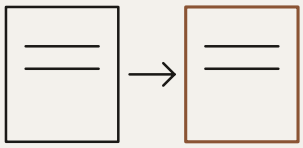


SYNC

The cupboard shows up as a drive on every laptop.

People open and save files as usual, from a drive letter such as G:. Changes travel to everyone automatically, including deletions and mistakes.

3



BACKUP

A photocopy kept in another building, by another company.

A separate service quietly copies the cupboard several times a day and keeps older copies. It is only used when something goes wrong.

THE ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Cloud storage is not a backup.

Because sync copies everything to everyone, a deleted folder, a drawing saved over, or a virus also spreads everywhere instantly. Google keeps old versions for only 30 days. A backup is a separate copy with a separate password, so it still has yesterday's healthy files.

WORDS YOU MAY HEAR, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Version history	Google remembers earlier saves of a file for 30 days, so you can go back to an older version.
Bin / Trash	Deleted files wait here for 30 days before they are gone for good.
Archive	Finished projects moved to a read-only folder so nobody changes them by accident.
NAS / server	A box of hard disks inside the studio. Fast on the office network, but MACK has to buy and look after it.
Offline drive	A portable hard disk kept unplugged in a safe. No internet or password breach can reach it.
TB (terabyte)	1 TB is about 1,000 GB, roughly 200,000 phone photos. MACK expects 2–3 TB to start.

What it looks like day to day. What happens when things go wrong.

Use these as examples on the call. Clients understand stories better than technology.

Morning: open a drawing

The designer opens **G:\MACK Projects\Garden House\03 CAD** and works in AutoCAD as usual. On save, it uploads by itself.

Sharing with a client

Instead of email attachments or WhatsApp, send a link to the **Final Deliverables** folder, for that person only, expiring in 30 days.

"I deleted a folder"

Restore it from the Bin in a minute. **Under 30 days: Bin. After that: the backup.**

"I saved over the final plan"

Right-click → version history → pick yesterday's version. **Under 30 days: Google. Older: the backup.**

Laptop stolen or dead

Nothing was only on it. Lock its access from the admin page and sign in on a new laptop. **Back to work in about an hour.**

Internet goes down

Folders marked **"available offline"** keep working. Changes upload when the internet returns. A phone hotspot works for urgent sends.

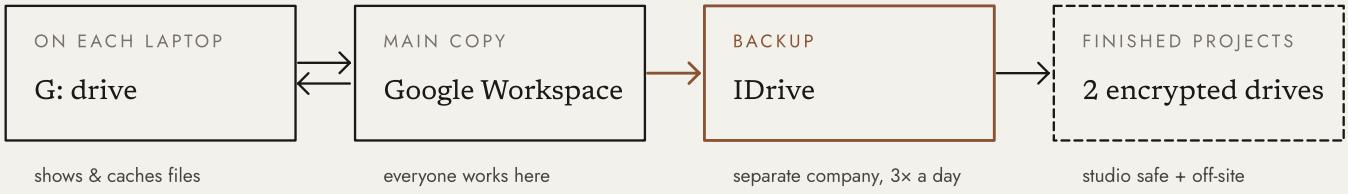
Virus / ransomware

Google's sync app notices and pauses. Roll files back to the clean version, or restore from the backup taken before the attack.

Studio fire or break-in

Main copy and backup are both online. Finished projects are also on a drive kept off-site. **Nothing important lives only in the studio.**

WHERE EVERY COPY LIVES



Ask these 8 questions first. Their answers choose the option.

You don't need to know what they want before the call. Ask these questions, note the answers, and the right option follows.

ASK	WHY IT MATTERS	IF THEY SAY… → THEN
1 How many people need access, now and in a year?	Cloud is priced per person. It also decides storage: Google gives 2 TB per person.	Under 10 → **Package A or B**. 10+ soon → keep **C** in mind.
2 Where are the files today, and roughly how big?	Tells you how much to move and how long it takes. About 3 TB is a week of uploading.	Over 10 TB → more people or **C**.
3 Which email do you use? Gmail or Outlook? Do you have a domain (@mack…)?	The cloud plan usually **includes** company email. Their habit points to Google or Microsoft.	No strong habit → **Google**. Deep in Outlook/Excel → discuss **Microsoft** (storage is the catch).
4 Windows or Mac? Windows Home or Pro?	Both work. Windows Home can't encrypt USB drives itself.	Home → buy drives with built-in encryption (priced in).
5 Do several people work on the **same** Revit model at the same time?	This is the one thing cloud folders do badly.	Yes, daily → **C** (studio server). No → **A/B**.
6 How is the studio internet? Speed, and how often does it drop?	Cloud-first depends on it. 100 Mbps fibre is comfortable.	Drops weekly → add a second connection before anything else.
7 How do you send files to clients and consultants now?	Shows if sharing (links, expiry, permissions) is a selling point for them.	WhatsApp/WeTransfer → stress **shared folder links**.
8 What budget feels comfortable: per month, and one-time?	A and B cost the same monthly. B adds a one-time ₹40,720.	Tight one-time → **A** now, drives later. Otherwise → **B**.

Also ask: **who in the studio will be the "admin"** (resets passwords, adds new staff), and whether they've **ever lost files**. A real past loss is the best reason for backup.

Let them choose, one row at a time. Prices for 5 people, per year.

The highlighted line is our suggestion in each step. All prices include 18% GST.

STEP 1 Where do the files live?

Google Workspace	10 TB shared by everyone. Company email included. Simple sharing links.	**₹76,464 / yr**	SUGGESTED
Microsoft 365	Cheaper per person and good if they live in Outlook/Excel. But only about 1 TB of *shared* space; 3 TB would add roughly ₹5.5 lakh a year.	**₹60,888 / yr**	ONLY IF DATA IS SMALL
Dropbox (+ separate email)	Best at syncing very large files fast. 15 TB or more. Costs about 2.4× Google.	**≈ ₹1,83,940 / yr**	IF BIG FILES LAG

STEP 2 Independent backup?

Yes: IDrive backup	Separate company, separate password, copies 3× a day, 10 TB per person. Hands-off.	**₹11,446 / yr**	SUGGESTED
No backup	Relies on Google's 30-day Bin and version history only. Not responsible for client work.	**₹0**	NOT ADVISED

STEP 3 A copy MACK physically holds?

Yes: 2 encrypted drives	WD My Passport 5 TB, password-locked. Finished projects copied on; one in the studio safe, one at a partner's home.	**₹40,720 once**	SUGGESTED
Not now	Can be added any time later.	**₹0**	IF BUDGET IS TIGHT

STEP 4 A storage server in the studio?

Not now	At 2–3 TB and ~5 people the cloud does the job. Hard disk prices are high in 2026.	**₹0**	SUGGESTED
Yes: Synology NAS	Fast shared work on big Revit models, plus a local copy. Needs a UPS and care.	**₹2,58,650 once**	10+ PEOPLE / REVIT

IDrive and Dropbox bill in US dollars; converted at $1 = ₹97. Google may offer new customers ₹864 instead of ₹1,080 per person for the first 12 months (saves ₹15,293 in Year 1). NAS = DS925+ ₹77,150 + 4 × 8 TB drives ₹1,75,100 + UPS ₹6,400.

Three ready-made packages. If they'd rather not choose line by line.

A

ESSENTIAL

Cloud + online backup. The minimum we'd call safe.

Google Workspace, 5 people
IDrive backup, 3× a day
No drives, no server

One-time	₹0
Per year	₹87,910
≈ per month	₹7,326
Year 1 total	₹87,910

SUGGESTED

B

RECOMMENDED

Essential + two encrypted drives holding every finished project.

Google Workspace, 5 people
IDrive backup, 3× a day
2 × 5 TB encrypted drives

One-time	₹40,720
Per year	₹87,910
≈ per month	₹7,326
Year 1 total	₹1,28,630

C

GROWTH

For ~10 people working together on big models.

Google Workspace, 10 people
IDrive + studio server + its backup
2 × 5 TB encrypted drives

One-time	₹2,99,370
Per year	₹2,23,550
≈ per month	₹18,629
Year 1 total	₹5,22,920

How to say the difference: A and B cost exactly the same every month. B adds ₹40,720 once, for a copy of finished projects that no internet problem, password leak or unpaid subscription can touch.

Each extra person adds about **₹17,582 a year** (Google ₹15,293 + backup ₹2,289), and 2 TB more shared storage. Start with A or B; move to C only if the "Revit together" or "10+ people" answers say so.

All prices include 18% GST and use Google's normal price (₹1,080 per person per month, yearly plan). Year 2 onwards = the "per year" line. Not included: internet, laptops, your setup fee.

Questions they may ask.
Short, honest answers.

"Is our data safe with Google?"

It's encrypted and protected by two-step sign-in for every person. The bigger risk is our own mistakes, which is what the backup is for.

"Why pay for backup if Google already stores it?"

Google copies mistakes too, and keeps old versions only 30 days. The backup is a separate copy at a separate company.

"Why not just use external hard disks?"

People forget to copy, and disks fail or get stolen. We use disks only as an extra copy of finished projects.

"Why not buy a server like other studios?"

At our size it costs about ₹2.6 lakh up front plus upkeep, for no gain. We'll add one if the team grows or Revit needs it.

"What if the internet goes down?"

Active projects are kept offline on laptops, so work continues and uploads later. A phone hotspot covers urgent sends.

"What if someone leaves?"

Files belong to MACK, not the person. We switch off their access the same day; nothing walks out.

"Can we stop or switch later?"

Yes. The files are normal DWG, RVT and PDF files and can be downloaded any time. The backup and drives hold copies too.

"Who owns the accounts?"

MACK does. The accounts are registered and paid by MACK; we only have admin access, which they can remove.

BEFORE THE CALL

- ☐ Have this pack open on page 3
- ☐ Note their answers to the 8 questions
- ☐ Don't promise a price in dollars; say "about"
- ☐ Confirm Google's price on screen from India
- ☐ Ask who will be MACK's admin contact
- ☐ End with a choice: A, B or C

IF YOU ONLY SAY ONE THING

"All your projects in one company account everyone can work from, a separate backup copying it three times a day, and finished work also kept on drives you hold, for about ₹7,300 a month."